



# San Mateo CA PD Transparency Portal

Last updated: Tue Sep 01 2026



privacy. San Mateo CA PD utilizes retroactive search to solve crimes after they've occurred. Additionally, San Mateo CA PD utilizes real time alerting of hotlist vehicles to capture wanted criminals. In an effort to ensure proper usage and guardrails are in place, they have made the below policies and usage statistics available to the public.

## Community Impact

### Data & Usage Summary

**Data Retention**

The number of days data is retained.

30 days

**Total Cameras**

Number of LPR and other cameras.

66

**Vehicles detected in the last 30 days**

Number of unique plate reads over the last 30 days.

885,021

**Hotlists Alerted On**

National and statewide hotlist sources.

California SVS, NCMEC Amber Alert

**Number of Hotlist Hits**

Total hotlist hits over the last 30 days.

4,333

Organizations granted access to San Mateo CA PD data.

Belmont CA PD

Brisbane CA PD

California Highway Patrol

East Palo Alto CA PD

Foster City CA PD

Palo Alto CA PD

South San Francisco CA PD

# Policy & Trust

## What's Detected

License Plates, Vehicles

## What's Not Detected

Facial recognition, People, Gender, Race

## Acceptable Use Policy

Data is used for law enforcement purposes only.  
Data is owned by San Mateo CA PD and is never sold to 3rd parties.

## Prohibited Uses

Immigration enforcement, traffic enforcement, harrassment or intimidation, usage based solely on a protected class (i.e. race, sex, religion), Personal use.

## Access Policy

All system access requires a valid reason and is stored indefinitely.

## Hotlist Policy

Hotlist hits are required to be human verified prior to action.

## Public Search Audit

Download to view searches performed over the last 30 days.

Download CSV

# More Info

**Policy Documents**

San Mateo PD Full Policy Manual can be found at the following link:  
<https://www.cityofsanmateo.org/DocumentCenter/View/79089/San-Mateo-PD-Policy-Manual>

**ALPR Policy**

<https://www.cityofsanmateo.org/DocumentCenter/View/99914/ALPR-Policy-12-23-2025>

**SOP**

<https://www.cityofsanmateo.org/DocumentCenter/View/102451/Automated-License-Plate-Reader-Operating-Procedure>